STATE OF WASHINGTON
DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL AND HEALTH SERVICES
COMMUNITY SERVICES DIVISION
Economic Services Administration
Post Office Box 45440 Olympia WA 98504-5440

April 27, 2026

Dear interested parties and community partners,

We are providing an update to our March 2, 2026, letter as we await a decision on Washington state's request to the federal government for major disaster assistance related to the December 2025 storms.

The catastrophic events affected some of the most vulnerable people in Washington state. The flooding left many without food, electricity, shelter and other resources. On January 21, 2026, Governor Bob Ferguson declared a state of emergency for multiple Washington counties and Tribal Nations and issued a statewide emergency proclamation. The president approved the request on April 7, 2026.

Now DSHS is requesting authorization from USDA's Food and Nutrition Service (FNS) to operate a Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, which is authorized at FNS discretion.

If FNS approves, then DSHS can operate D-SNAP for up to seven days after the approval is received for the specific counties and Tribal Nations listed below.

Counties

- Chelan
- Grays Harbor
- King
- Lewis
- Pacific
- Pierce
- Skagit
- Snohomish
- Thurston
- Whatcom

Tribes and Tribal Nations

- Confederated Tribes of the Chehalis Reservation
- Lummi Nation
- Muckleshoot Indian Tribe
- Nisqually Indian Tribe
- Nooksack Indian Tribe
- Puyallup Tribe
- Quinault Indian Nation

- Samish Indian Nation
- Sauk-Suiattle Indian Tribe
- Shoalwater Bay Indian Tribe
- Snoqualmie Indian Tribe
- Squaxin Island Tribe
- Stillaguamish Tribe of Indians
- Swinomish Indian Tribal Community
- Tulalip Tribes
- Upper Skagit Indian Tribe

D-SNAP benefit

D-SNAP would provide one month of food assistance benefits to qualifying households that did not already receive SNAP or Food Assistance Program benefits for December 2025 or Food Distribution Program on Indian Reservations after the disaster in December 2025. Those funds would be deposited into a customer's Electronic Benefits Transfer account, which they could access through their EBT card.

To be eligible for D-SNAP, a household must have lived or worked in the identified disaster area at the time of the disaster, have been affected by the disaster and meet certain D-SNAP eligibility criteria.

D-SNAP application process

A D-SNAP application and interview are required to determine eligibility. If approved by FNS, households could apply within the specified application period (dates will be shared as soon as we have them). They can apply by:

- Calling a DSHS toll-free number dedicated to D-SNAP applications. The phone number and service hours will be shared when available.
- Going to a local Community Services Office in the counties affected by the disaster.
- Visiting a DSHS mobile office or other designated site.

All D-SNAP applications and eligibility interviews must be completed within the approved seven-day period.

DSHS will notify you when we know more.

If you have any questions, please contact Freda Cogger, Tribal Relations Program administrator, at Freda.Cogger@dshs.wa.gov or 360-522-2155.

Thank you for your continued collaboration.

With respect,

Brice Montgomery, Director
Community Services Division, ESA
Washington State Department of Social and Health Services